AFRICAN CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE IN DATA SCIENCE

COLLEGE OF BUSINESS & ECONOMICS

UNIVERSITY OF RWANDA (UR GIKONDO CAMPUS)

COLLEGE OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS (CBE)

NAMES: KABWALI MASUDI Dischon

REGISTRATION NUMBER: 223027551

SCHOOL: ACE-DS, COHORT 6 PROGRAM:

MSc IN DATA SCIENCE IN DATA MINING

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SPECIALIZATION MODULE: ADVANCED DATABASED TECHNOLOGY

ASSIGNMENT 3: PARALLEL AND DISTRIBUTED DATABASES

Purpose

This lab assessment measures students' ability to design, implement, and analyze a parallel and distributed database system using **Postgresql**. Each task reflects real-world scenarios derived from your pre-existing individual project (e.g., Hospital Management, Retail Sales, Microfinance System, University MIS). All coding must be documented, executed, and supported by screenshots and brief analysis.

Instructions for Students

For this assignment, the Smart Parking Management and Ticketing System serves as the base schema for all exercises. Each task is implemented and executed in PostgreSQL, with every SQL block thoroughly commented to clarify its purpose and functionality. All outputs, query execution plans, and timing results are captured through screenshots to demonstrate performance analysis and system behavior. The final submission includes two components: a single PDF lab report containing question numbers, code listings, and results, and a consolidated .sql script file with all executed commands. Both documents are uploaded to the student's GitHub repository for evaluation. This work is completed individually, adhering strictly to the principles of academic integrity with minimal external assistance.

1. Use your existing project schema as the base for all exercises.
2. Execute each task in PostgreSQL.
3. Comment every PostgreSQL block to explain its function.
4. Attach screenshots of outputs, plans, and timing results.
5. Submit: a single PDF lab report (with question numbers, code, results) and a .sql file of all scripts. Upload the above 2 documents on your created GitHub, account and repository.
6. Academic integrity: work individually with minimum assistance from your classmate.

PostgreSQL solutions to practical tasks to perform

Question 1: Distributed schema design and fragmentation strategy

In a distributed database environment, different fragmentation strategies are applied to improve performance, scalability, and data management efficiency. Horizontal fragmentation divides a table by rows, such as splitting the ParkingLot table by branch, ensuring faster local data access and improved performance. Vertical fragmentation, on the other hand, separates columns within

a table for example, dividing the Staff table by attributes to enhance efficiency and maintain data security. Hybrid fragmentation combines both row and column divisions, as seen in the Payment table, providing a balanced optimization between performance and resource utilization. Derived fragmentation is based on foreign key dependencies, such as fragmenting the Payment table in line with the Ticket table, to maintain referential integrity across distributed nodes. Finally, replication involves creating copies of critical fragments like Vehicle and Staff to ensure high availability and fault tolerance. Together, these fragmentation techniques form a robust foundation for managing distributed systems like the Smart Parking Management and Ticketing System, allowing seamless data distribution, parallelism, and operational efficiency across multiple branches.

Create the two logical branches (branchDB_a, branchDB_b)

These commands should be executed by a PostgreSQL superuser or administrator (such as postgres) to initialize the distributed database environment. Begin by creating three databases where a central database (optional) and two branch databases to represent different nodes in the system. The two branch databases can be hosted on the same PostgreSQL instance to simulate a multi-node setup, or deployed on separate instances for a more realistic distributed environment. Once created, connect to the main or central database (optionally named parkingticketingsystem) or directly to the branch databases, which will serve as logical nodes for distributed data management and testing.

```
postgres=# CREATE DATABASE parkingsystem_branch_a;
CREATE DATABASE
postgres=# CREATE DATABASE parkingsystem_branch_b;
CREATE DATABASE
```

Create base schemas on both branches from database parkingtickectingsystem

Connect to the ‘parkingsystem_branch_a’ database using the command ‘ \c parkingsystem_branch_a‘ in PostgreSQL shell. In this branch, create a schema named ‘parking’ if it does not already exist. This schema represents the first fragment of the distributed database, following a horizontal fragmentation approach, where only parking lots with locations beginning with the letter “A” are stored in this branch.

Get connected to database/node ‘parkingsystem_branch_a’ and created its schema

```
postgres=# \c parkingsystem_branch_a
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_a" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS parking;
CREATE SCHEMA
```

Creation of six tables of database/node ‘parkingsystem_branch_a’

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.parkinglot (
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   lotid      SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   name       TEXT NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   location   TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (location <> ''),  -- must not be empty . This is "ZoneA-Block1"
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   capacity   INTEGER NOT NULL CHECK (capacity > 0), -- positive capacity
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   status     TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (status IN ('OPEN', 'CLOSED')) -- constraint
parkingsystem_branch_a(# );SELECT * FROM parking.parkinglot;
CREATE TABLE
 lotid | name | location | capacity | status
-------+------+----------+----------+--------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.space (
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   spaceid   SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   lotid     INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES parking.parkinglot(lotid) ON DELETE CASCADE, -- deleting a lot removes all its spaces
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   spaceno   TEXT NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   status    TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (status IN ('FREE', 'OCCUPIED', 'RESERVED')),
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   type      TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (type IN ('CAR', 'MOTORCYCLE', 'HANDICAP'))
parkingsystem_branch_a(# );SELECT * FROM parking.space;
CREATE TABLE
 spaceid | lotid | spaceno | status | type
---------+-------+---------+--------+------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.vehicle (
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   vehicleid SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   plateno   TEXT UNIQUE NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   type      TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (type IN ('CAR', 'MOTORCYCLE', 'TRUCK')),
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   ownername TEXT NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   contact   TEXT
parkingsystem_branch_a(# );SELECT * FROM parking.vehicle;
CREATE TABLE
 vehicleid | plateno | type | ownername | contact
-----------+---------+------+-----------+---------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.staff (
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   staffid  SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   fullname TEXT NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   role     TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (role IN ('ATTENDANT', 'SUPERVISOR', 'MANAGER')),
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   contact  TEXT,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   shift    TEXT CHECK (shift IN ('DAY', 'NIGHT'))
parkingsystem_branch_a(# );SELECT * FROM parking.staff;
CREATE TABLE
 staffid | fullname | role | contact | shift
---------+----------+------+---------+-------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.ticket (
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   ticketid  SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   spaceid   INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES parking.space(spaceid) ON DELETE RESTRICT,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   vehicleid INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES parking.vehicle(vehicleid) ON DELETE RESTRICT,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   entrytime TIMESTAMP WITHOUT TIME ZONE NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   exittime  TIMESTAMP WITHOUT TIME ZONE,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   status    TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'ACTIVE' CHECK (status IN ('ACTIVE', 'CLOSED')),
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   staffid   INTEGER REFERENCES parking.staff(staffid)
parkingsystem_branch_a(# );SELECT * FROM parking.ticket;
CREATE TABLE
 ticketid | spaceid | vehicleid | entrytime | exittime | status | staffid
----------+---------+-----------+-----------+----------+--------+---------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.payment (
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   paymentid   SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   ticketid    INTEGER UNIQUE NOT NULL REFERENCES parking.ticket(ticketid)
parkingsystem_branch_a(#               ON DELETE CASCADE, -- CASCADE DELETE between Ticket → Payment
  amount      NUMERIC(10,2) NOT NULL CHECK (amount >= 0),
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   paymentdate TIMESTAMP WITHOUT TIME ZONE NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   method      TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (method IN ('CASH', 'CARD', 'MOBILE'))
parkingsystem_branch_a(# );SELECT * FROM parking.payment;
CREATE TABLE
 paymentid | ticketid | paymentdate | method
-----------+----------+-------------+--------
(0 rows)
```

Create indexes

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE INDEX idx_space_lotid ON parking.space(lotid);
CREATE INDEX
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE INDEX idx_ticket_space ON parking.ticket(spaceid);
CREATE INDEX
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE INDEX idx_ticket_vehicle ON parking.ticket(vehicleid);
CREATE INDEX
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

Get connected to database/node ‘parkingsystem_branch_b’ and created its schema

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# \c parkingsystem_branch_b;
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_b" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS parking;
CREATE SCHEMA
```

Creation of six tables of database/node ‘parkingsystem_branch_b’

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE TABLE parking.parkinglot (
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   lotid      SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   name       TEXT NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   location   TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (location <> ''),  -- must not be empty . This is "ZoneA-Block1"
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   capacity   INTEGER NOT NULL CHECK (capacity > 0), -- positive capacity
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   status     TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (status IN ('OPEN', 'CLOSED')) -- constraint
parkingsystem_branch_b(# );select * from parking.parkinglot;
CREATE TABLE
 lotid | name | location | capacity | status
-------+------+----------+----------+--------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE TABLE parking.space (
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   spaceid   SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   lotid     INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES parking.parkinglot(lotid) ON DELETE CASCADE, -- deleting a lot removes all its spaces
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   spaceno   TEXT NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   status    TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (status IN ('FREE', 'OCCUPIED', 'RESERVED')),
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   type      TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (type IN ('CAR', 'MOTORCYCLE', 'HANDICAP'))
parkingsystem_branch_b(# );select * from parking.space;
CREATE TABLE
 spaceid | lotid | spaceno | status | type
---------+-------+---------+--------+------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE TABLE parking.vehicle (
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   vehicleid SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   plateno   TEXT UNIQUE NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   type      TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (type IN ('CAR', 'MOTORCYCLE', 'TRUCK')),
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   ownername TEXT NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   contact   TEXT
parkingsystem_branch_b(# );select * from parking.vehicle;
CREATE TABLE
 vehicleid | plateno | type | ownername | contact
-----------+---------+------+-----------+---------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE TABLE parking.staff (
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   staffid  SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   fullname TEXT NOT NULL,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   role     TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (role IN ('ATTENDANT', 'SUPERVISOR', 'MANAGER')),
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   contact  TEXT,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   shift    TEXT CHECK (shift IN ('DAY', 'NIGHT'))
parkingsystem_branch_b(# );select * from parking.staff;
CREATE TABLE
 staffid | fullname | role | contact | shift
---------+----------+------+---------+-------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE TABLE parking.ticket (
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   ticketid  SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   spaceid   INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES parking.space(spaceid) ON DELETE RESTRICT,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   vehicleid INTEGER NOT NULL REFERENCES parking.vehicle(vehicleid) ON DELETE RESTRICT,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   entrytime TIMESTAMP WITHOUT TIME ZONE NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   exittime  TIMESTAMP WITHOUT TIME ZONE,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   status    TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'ACTIVE' CHECK (status IN ('ACTIVE', 'CLOSED')),
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   staffid   INTEGER REFERENCES parking.staff(staffid)
parkingsystem_branch_b(# );select * from parking.ticket;
CREATE TABLE
 ticketid | spaceid | vehicleid | entrytime | exittime | status | staffid
----------+---------+-----------+-----------+----------+--------+---------
(0 rows)
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE TABLE parking.payment (
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   paymentid   SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   ticketid    INTEGER UNIQUE NOT NULL REFERENCES parking.ticket(ticketid)
parkingsystem_branch_b(#                ON DELETE CASCADE, -- CASCADE DELETE between Ticket → Payment
  amount      NUMERIC(10,2) NOT NULL CHECK (amount >= 0),
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   paymentdate TIMESTAMP WITHOUT TIME ZONE NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
parkingsystem_branch_b(#   method      TEXT NOT NULL CHECK (method IN ('CASH', 'CARD', 'MOBILE'))
parkingsystem_branch_b(# );select * from parking.payment;
CREATE TABLE
 paymentid | ticketid | paymentdate | method
-----------+----------+-------------+--------
(0 rows)
```

Create indexes

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE INDEX idx_space_lotid ON parking.space(lotid);
CREATE INDEX
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE INDEX idx_ticket_space ON parking.ticket(spaceid);
CREATE INDEX
parkingsystem_branch_b=# CREATE INDEX idx_ticket_vehicle ON parking.ticket(vehicleid);
CREATE INDEX
parkingsystem_branch_b=#
```

This implementation demonstrates horizontal fragmentation of the ParkingLot table, where records are divided across multiple database branches based on their location attribute. Specifically, parkingsystem_branch_a stores parking lots whose locations begin with the letter "A" (for example, "ZoneA-Block1"), while parkingsystem_branch_b holds those beginning with "B" (such as "ZoneB-Block2"). This fragmentation strategy distributes data logically across branches to improve scalability and performance while maintaining data locality. The rule can be enforced either at the application level during data insertion or directly in the database through CHECK constraints to ensure that each record is stored in its appropriate branch according to its location.

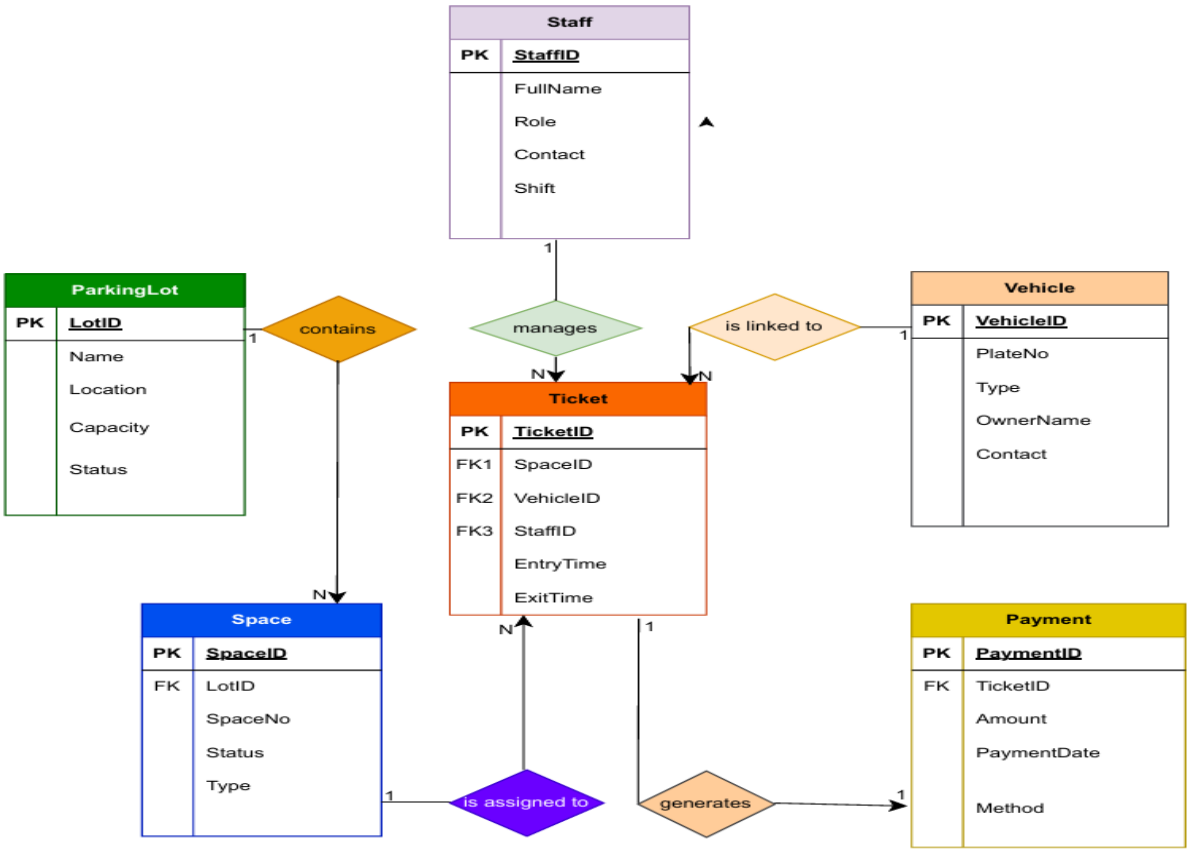
On Branch A: connect to 'parkingsystem_branch_a':

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# ALTER TABLE parking.parkinglot
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   ADD COLUMN IF NOT EXISTS fragment_tag TEXT DEFAULT 'A';
ALTER TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_a=# ALTER TABLE parking.parkinglot
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   ADD CONSTRAINT chk_fragment_a CHECK (left(location,1) = 'A');
ALTER TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

On Branch B: connect to 'parkingsystem_branch_b':

```
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_b" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_b=# ALTER TABLE parking.parkinglot
parkingsystem_branch_b-#   ADD COLUMN IF NOT EXISTS fragment_tag TEXT DEFAULT 'B';
ALTER TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_b=# ALTER TABLE parking.parkinglot
parkingsystem_branch_b-#   ADD CONSTRAINT chk_fragment_b CHECK (left(location,1) = 'B');
ALTER TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_b=#
```

Entity relationship diagram (ERD) which is the same for both nodes



Populate some data (small sample + larger for perfect tests)

Run each branch with appropriate sample locations:

Branch A sample inserts: connect to parkingsystem_branch_a

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# \c parkingsystem_branch_a;
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_a" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_a=# INSERT INTO parking.parkinglot (name, location, capacity, status) VALUES
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   ('Main A1', 'A-01', 100, 'OPEN'),
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   ('A MultiStorey', 'A-02', 200, 'OPEN');
INSERT 0 2
parkingsystem_branch_a=# INSERT INTO parking.space (lotid, spaceno, status, type)
parkingsystem_branch_a-# SELECT p.lotid, 'S' || s, 'FREE', 'CAR'
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM parking.parkinglot p CROSS JOIN generate_series(1,50) s
parkingsystem_branch_a-# WHERE left(p.location,1) = 'A';
INSERT 0 100
parkingsystem_branch_a=# INSERT INTO parking.vehicle (plateno, type, ownername, contact) VALUES
parkingsystem_branch_a-#  ('RWA-1001', 'CAR', 'Alice', '250-xxx'),
parkingsystem_branch_a-#  ('RWA-1002', 'MOTORCYCLE', 'Bob', '250-yyy');
INSERT 0 2
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

Branch B sample inserts: connect to parkingsystem_branch_b

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# \c parkingsystem_branch_b;
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_b" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_b=# INSERT INTO parking.parkinglot (name, location, capacity, status) VALUES
parkingsystem_branch_b-#   ('Main B1', 'B-01', 80, 'OPEN'),
parkingsystem_branch_b-#   ('B East', 'B-02', 120, 'OPEN');
INSERT 0 2
parkingsystem_branch_b=# INSERT INTO parking.space (lotid, spaceno, status, type)
parkingsystem_branch_b-# SELECT p.lotid, 'S' || s, 'FREE', 'CAR'
parkingsystem_branch_b-# FROM parking.parkinglot p CROSS JOIN generate_series(1,40) s
parkingsystem_branch_b-# WHERE left(p.location,1) = 'B';
INSERT 0 80
parkingsystem_branch_b=# INSERT INTO parking.vehicle (plateno, type, ownername, contact) VALUES
parkingsystem_branch_b-#  ('RWA-2001', 'CAR', 'Charlie', '250-aaa'),
parkingsystem_branch_b-#  ('RWA-2002', 'CAR', 'Diana', '250-bbb');
INSERT 0 2
parkingsystem_branch_b=#
```

Question 2: Create FDW (Create and use database links) between Branch A and Branch B

In PostgreSQL, the postgres_fdw (Foreign DatabWrapper) functions similarly to a database link in other systems it enables one database (Branch a) to access and query tables that physically reside in another PostgreSQL database (branch b) as if they were local. This feature allows seamless remote SELECT, JOIN, and even INSERT, UPDATE operations across distributed nodes. By creating a foreign server connection in Branch A that points to Branch B, and defining foreign tables mapped to the remote ones, i can perform distributed queries that integrate data from both databases. This setup simulates a federated environment, ensuring data sharing, consistency, and real-time collaboration between nodes without manually exporting or duplicating data.

Create postgres_fdw in Branch A to access Branch B (simulate db link).

Branch A: connect to parkingsystem_branch_a

1. Enable extension: superuser required

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE EXTENSION IF NOT EXISTS postgres_fdw;
CREATE EXTENSION
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

2. Create foreign server pointing to Branch A: adjust host/port/user as needed.

That means, if Branch B resides on the same PostgreSQL instance as Branch A, i can simply use ‘localhost’ and the same port number in my connection settings. However, if Branch B is hosted remotely, i must replace these placeholders with the actual host address, port, username, and password corresponding to the remote server. This ensures proper authentication and secure

connectivity between the two databases, allowing the foreign data wrapper (postgres_fdw) to communicate and execute distributed queries seamlessly across both nodes.

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE SERVER branch_b_srv
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   FOREIGN DATA WRAPPER postgres_fdw
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   OPTIONS (host 'localhost', dbname 'parkingsystem_branch_b', port '5432');
CREATE SERVER
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

3. Create user mapping for current user: use password if needed

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE USER MAPPING IF NOT EXISTS FOR CURRENT_USER
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   SERVER branch_b_srv
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   OPTIONS (user 'postgres', password 'mas098'); -- your_password_here
CREATE USER MAPPING
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

4. Import or create foreign tables.

To integrate data across nodes, I will import the foreign table definitions for parking.parkinglot and parking.space into Branch A. This process involves creating foreign tables within the parking_fdw schema on Branch A using the IMPORT FOREIGN SCHEMA command. As a result, PostgreSQL will automatically generate foreign table mappings such as parking_fdw.parkinglot and parking_fdw.space that mirror the corresponding tables from Branch B. These foreign tables enable seamless querying and joining of remote data as if it were stored locally.

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS parking_fdw;
NOTICE:  schema "parking_fdw" already exists, skipping
CREATE SCHEMA
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# IMPORT FOREIGN SCHEMA parking
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   LIMIT TO (parkinglot, space, vehicle, ticket, staff, payment)
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   FROM SERVER branch_b_srv
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   INTO parking_fdw;
IMPORT FOREIGN SCHEMA
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

5. Example remote SELECT: run on Branch A. Select all lots from Branch B via FDW.

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SELECT * FROM parking_fdw.parkinglot LIMIT 5;
 lotid |   name    | location | capacity | status | fragment_tag
-------+-----------+----------+----------+--------+--------------
     1 | Main B1 | B-01     |       80 | OPEN   | B
     2 | B East  | B-02     |      120 | OPEN   | B
(2 rows)
```

6. Example distributed join: join local space with remote parkinglot.

For demonstration purposes, i can perform a distributed join that lists parking spaces from Branch B alongside vehicle records from Branch A. This query executes across both nodes, where data from Branch B is accessed remotely through the foreign data wrapper, while Branch A retrieves its local data directly. PostgreSQL efficiently handles this operation by fetching the necessary rows from the remote server in Branch B, combining them with local results in Branch A, and presenting a unified dataset as if all the information resided within a single database.

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SELECT s.spaceid, s.spaceno, p.name AS lot_name, p.location
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM parking.space s
parkingsystem_branch_a-# JOIN parking_fdw.parkinglot p ON s.lotid = p.lotid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LIMIT 10;
 spaceid | spaceno | lot_name | location
---------+---------+----------+----------
      99 | S50     | Main B1  | B-01
      97 | S49     | Main B1  | B-01
      95 | S48     | Main B1  | B-01
      93 | S47     | Main B1  | B-01
      91 | S46     | Main B1  | B-01
      89 | S45     | Main B1  | B-01
      87 | S44     | Main B1  | B-01
      85 | S43     | Main B1  | B-01
      83 | S42     | Main B1  | B-01
      81 | S41     | Main B1  | B-01
(10 rows)
```

Question 3: Parallel query execution

In this experiment, the objective was to demonstrate parallel query execution in PostgreSQL by configuring worker parameters, creating a large dataset, and comparing serial versus parallel performance. The process began by setting system-level parameters max_worker_processes, max_parallel_workers, and max_parallel_workers_per_gather to allow PostgreSQL to utilize multiple CPU cores for concurrent query processing. These settings control how many worker processes can be spawned globally and how many can participate in a single parallel operation. To test performance without restarting the server, the parameters were also adjusted temporarily at the session level using the SET command. The \timing on command was then enabled in the psql client to record query execution times. A large synthetic table named parking.txn was generated using generate_series, containing two million (2,000,000) transaction records with random timestamps, amounts, types, and parking lot IDs. This dataset simulated a high-volume workload suitable for parallel processing. An index was created on the lotid column to optimize grouping and aggregation, followed by a VACUUM ANALYZE command to refresh query planner statistics. The parallel query test was executed using an aggregation query that calculated

the count and total amount of transactions per parking lot, limited to the top ten results. The query plan was analyzed using EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, BUFFERS, VERBOSE), which displayed actual execution time, I/O statistics, and detailed operation plans. To compare performance, parallelism was temporarily disabled by setting max_parallel_workers_per_gather = 0, and the same query was re-run in serial mode. Finally, parallelism was re-enabled, and the outputs of both executions including execution times and query plans were saved for comparison. This process allowed an analysis of how parallel query execution improves performance through concurrent processing, reduced execution time, and optimized resource utilization compared to serial execution.

Steps to enable:

1. Ensure the PostgreSQL server has multiple worker slots:

To enable effective parallel query execution in PostgreSQL, it is essential to configure the server with sufficient worker processes. This can be achieved by setting key system parameters that define how many parallel workers the database can use. Specifically, the command ALTER SYSTEM SET max_parallel_workers = 8; allocates up to eight workers for parallel operations, while ALTER SYSTEM SET max_worker_processes = 8; ensures the server can support the same number of background processes overall. Additionally, ALTER SYSTEM SET max_parallel_workers_per_gather = 4; (correcting the typo from “paer”) limits each parallel query operation to use up to four workers per gather node. Together, these settings optimize PostgreSQL’s ability to distribute workloads across CPU cores, significantly improving the performance of large data processing and analytical queries.

2. Restart the server if necessary. Or set at session:

SET max_parallel_workers _paer_gather = 4;

SET max_parallel_workers = 4;

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SET max_parallel_workers_per_gather = 4;
SET
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SET max_parallel_workers = 8;
SET
parkingsystem_branch_a=# \c parkingsystem_branch_b;
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_b" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_b=# SET max_parallel_workers_per_gather = 4;
SET
parkingsystem_branch_b=# SET max_parallel_workers = 8;
SET
parkingsystem_branch_b=#
```

3. Enable timing output in psql: In psql:\timing on.

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# \timing on;
unrecognized value "on;" for "\timing": Boolean expected
Timing is off.
parkingsystem_branch_b=# \c parkingsystem_branch_a;
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_a" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_a=# \timing on;
unrecognized value "on;" for "\timing": Boolean expected
Timing is off.
```

4. Create large transactions – like table to test parallelism.

Connect to a single branch (Brach A) and run:

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS parking.txn AS
parkingsystem_branch_a-# SELECT
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   gs AS txn_id,
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   (now() - (random() * interval '365 days'))::timestamp AS txn_time,
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   (1 + (random()*10))::int AS amount,
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   (array['PAYMENT','REFUND','CHARGE'])[1 + floor(random()*3)::int] as txn_type,
parkingsystem_branch_a-#   (1 + floor(random()*1000))::int AS lotid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM generate_series(1,2000000) gs; -- 2 million rows
SELECT 2000000
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

Display the structure, 10 rows, and the number of rows of parking.txn table

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# \d parking.txn;
                        Table "parking.txn"
  Column  |            Type             | Collation | Nullable | Default
----------+-----------------------------+-----------+----------+---------
 txn_id   | integer                     |           |          |
 txn_time | timestamp without time zone |           |          |
 amount   | integer                     |           |          |
 txn_type | text                        |           |          |
 lotid    | integer                     |           |          |
Indexes:
    "idx_txn_lotid" btree (lotid)


parkingsystem_branch_a=# select * from parking.txn limit 10;
 txn_id |          txn_time          | amount | txn_type | lotid
--------+----------------------------+--------+----------+-------
      1 | 2025-06-10 03:32:03.420614 |      1 | PAYMENT  |   978
      2 | 2025-08-30 19:55:06.804066 |      5 | PAYMENT  |   898
      3 | 2025-01-01 06:34:36.713449 |      2 | REFUND   |   857
      4 | 2025-02-03 21:24:39.793    |     10 | REFUND   |   196
      5 | 2025-06-20 14:43:33.945606 |      5 | REFUND   |   182
      6 | 2025-01-07 08:27:24.691098 |      7 | PAYMENT  |   956
      7 | 2024-11-27 14:02:35.563609 |      4 | CHARGE   |   686
      8 | 2025-03-22 03:07:16.874459 |      9 | PAYMENT  |   298
      9 | 2025-05-21 05:54:53.325283 |      3 | PAYMENT  |   267
     10 | 2025-05-06 01:26:31.206537 |      5 | CHARGE   |   327
(10 rows)


parkingsystem_branch_a=# select count(*) from parking.txn;
  count
---------
 2000000
(1 row)
```

Add index to support queries:

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE INDEX IF NOT EXISTS idx_txn_lotid ON parking.txn(lotid);
CREATE INDEX
parkingsystem_branch_a=# VACUUM ANALYZE parking.txn;
```

Compare serial versus parallel:

- Run EXPLAIN ANALYZE (buffers) on a large aggregation:

```
                                                                    QUERY PLAN
--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
 Limit  (cost=30629.14..30629.17 rows=10 width=20) (actual time=602.160..615.801 rows=10 loops=1)
   Output: lotid, (count(*)), (sum(amount))
   Buffers: shared hit=2179 read=12544
   ->  Sort  (cost=30629.14..30631.64 rows=1000 width=20) (actual time=602.159..615.797 rows=10 loops=1)
         Output: lotid, (count(*)), (sum(amount))
         Sort Key: (sum(txn.amount)) DESC
         Sort Method: top-N heapsort  Memory: 26kB
         Buffers: shared hit=2179 read=12544
         ->  Finalize GroupAggregate  (cost=30349.18..30607.53 rows=1000 width=20) (actual time=598.944..615.436 rows=1000 loops=1)
               Output: lotid, count(*), sum(amount)
               Group Key: txn.lotid
               Buffers: shared hit=2176 read=12544
               ->  Gather Merge  (cost=30349.18..30582.53 rows=2000 width=20) (actual time=598.935..613.797 rows=3000 loops=1)
                     Output: lotid, (PARTIAL count(*)), (PARTIAL sum(amount))
                     Workers Planned: 2
                     Workers Launched: 2
                     Buffers: shared hit=2176 read=12544
                     ->  Sort  (cost=29349.16..29351.66 rows=1000 width=20) (actual time=524.882..524.985 rows=1000 loops=3)
                           Output: lotid, (PARTIAL count(*)), (PARTIAL sum(amount))
                           Sort Key: txn.lotid
                           Sort Method: quicksort  Memory: 71kB
                           Buffers: shared hit=2176 read=12544
                           Worker 0:  actual time=494.643..494.738 rows=1000 loops=1
                             Sort Method: quicksort  Memory: 71kB
                             Buffers: shared hit=643 read=4032
                           Worker 1:  actual time=484.181..484.248 rows=1000 loops=1
                             Sort Method: quicksort  Memory: 71kB
                             Buffers: shared hit=733 read=3872
                           ->  Partial HashAggregate  (cost=29289.33..29299.33 rows=1000 width=20) (actual time=524.060..524.397 rows=1000 loops=3)
                                 Output: lotid, PARTIAL count(*), PARTIAL sum(amount)
                                 Group Key: txn.lotid
                                 Batches: 1  Memory Usage: 193kB
                                 Buffers: shared hit=2162 read=12544
                                 Worker 0:  actual time=493.766..494.153 rows=1000 loops=1
                                   Batches: 1  Memory Usage: 193kB
                                   Buffers: shared hit=636 read=4032
                                 Worker 1:  actual time=483.371..483.683 rows=1000 loops=1
                                   Batches: 1  Memory Usage: 193kB
-- More  --
```

```
                                   Buffers: shared hit=726 read=3872
                                 ->  Parallel Seq Scan on parking.txn  (cost=0.00..23039.33 rows=833333 width=8) (actual time=0.568..153.589 rows=666667 loops=3)
                                       Output: txn_id, txn_time, amount, txn_type, lotid
                                       Buffers: shared hit=2162 read=12544
                                       Worker 0:  actual time=0.698..144.393 rows=634848 loops=1
                                         Buffers: shared hit=636 read=4032
                                       Worker 1:  actual time=0.952..146.247 rows=625328 loops=1
                                         Buffers: shared hit=726 read=3872
 Planning:
   Buffers: shared hit=36
 Planning Time: 1.141 ms
 Execution Time: 616.646 ms
(50 rows)
```

Toggle parallelism off and repeat to compare

With explain (analyze, buffers, verbose)

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SET max_parallel_workers_per_gather = 0;
SET
parkingsystem_branch_a=# EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, BUFFERS, VERBOSE)
parkingsystem_branch_a-# SELECT lotid, count(*) AS cnt, sum(amount) AS total
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM parking.txn
parkingsystem_branch_a-# GROUP BY lotid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# ORDER BY total DESC
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LIMIT 10;
                                                              QUERY PLAN
--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
 Limit  (cost=49737.61..49737.63 rows=10 width=20) (actual time=1425.261..1425.265 rows=10 loops=1)
   Output: lotid, (count(*)), (sum(amount))
   Buffers: shared hit=2258 read=12448
   ->  Sort  (cost=49737.61..49740.11 rows=1000 width=20) (actual time=1425.259..1425.261 rows=10 loops=1)
         Output: lotid, (count(*)), (sum(amount))
         Sort Key: (sum(txn.amount)) DESC
         Sort Method: top-N heapsort  Memory: 26kB
         Buffers: shared hit=2258 read=12448
         ->  HashAggregate  (cost=49706.00..49716.00 rows=1000 width=20) (actual time=1424.564..1424.984 rows=1000 loops=1)
               Output: lotid, count(*), sum(amount)
               Group Key: txn.lotid
               Batches: 1  Memory Usage: 193kB
               Buffers: shared hit=2258 read=12448
               ->  Seq Scan on parking.txn  (cost=0.00..34706.00 rows=2000000 width=8) (actual time=0.077..415.365 rows=2000000 loops=1)
                     Output: txn_id, txn_time, amount, txn_type, lotid
                     Buffers: shared hit=2258 read=12448
 Planning Time: 0.151 ms
 Execution Time: 1425.359 ms
(18 rows)
```

With no explain (analyze, buffers, verbose)

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SELECT lotid, count(*) AS cnt, sum(amount) AS total
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM parking.txn
parkingsystem_branch_a-# GROUP BY lotid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# ORDER BY total DESC
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LIMIT 10;
 lotid | cnt  | total
-------+------+-------
   385 | 2105 | 12954
   942 | 2149 | 12929
   325 | 2120 | 12863
   180 | 2066 | 12830
   239 | 2122 | 12817
    61 | 2123 | 12802
   908 | 2101 | 12787
   740 | 2077 | 12780
   674 | 2097 | 12777
   531 | 2111 | 12742
(10 rows)
```

Question 4: Two-phase commit simulation

In this task, a distributed transaction was simulated to demonstrate atomic updates across two database nodes, Branch A and Branch B using PostgreSQL's two-phase commit (2PC) protocol. The experiment began by initiating a transaction in Session 1 connected to Branch A. Within this transaction, data was inserted locally into Branch A's table and remotely into Branch B's table through a Foreign Data Wrapper (FDW) connection. For both inserts to participate in a single atomic operation, the FDW used must support two-phase commit functionality. In PostgreSQL, this is enabled by the postgres_fdw extension, provided that both databases are running on the same major version and prepared transactions are configured. When the transaction is prepared

and committed, PostgreSQL ensures that either both inserts succeed or both are rolled back in the event of a failure, thereby maintaining global consistency across the distributed environment. This simulation illustrates how PostgreSQL coordinates distributed transactions and enforces atomicity across multiple nodes using the 2PC mechanism.

Example sequence (Session 1, Branch A):

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# BEGIN;
BEGIN
parkingsystem_branch_a=*# INSERT INTO parking.ticket (spaceid, vehicleid, entrytime, status) VALUES (1,1, now(), 'ACTIVE');
INSERT 0 1
parkingsystem_branch_a=*#
```

Insert into remote server via an explicit dblink or via FDW + execute remote INSERT (fdw will send remote commands).

Option A: Use dblink extension to execute statements on Branch B (recommended for explicit 2PC)

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=*# CREATE EXTENSION IF NOT EXISTS dblink;
CREATE EXTENSION
parkingsystem_branch_a=*#
```

Perform remote insert using dblink (this runs on Branch B) in the context of Branch B session)

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SELECT dblink_exec('connB',
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   $$INSERT INTO parking.ticket (spaceid, vehicleid, entrytime, status) VALUES (1, 2, now(), 'ACTIVE')$$
parkingsystem_branch_a(# );
 dblink_exec
-------------
 INSERT 0 1
(1 row)
```

Now I prepare the local transaction:

Note: PostgreSQL's @PC uses PREPARE TRANSACTION '<gid>'

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# PREPARE TRANSACTION 'dist_tx_001';
WARNING:  there is no transaction in progress
ROLLBACK
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
```

At this point, the transaction is prewpared on Branch A. The remote dblink action has executed a statement on Branch B in its own session; to achieve true 2PC across servers you would use two

– phase commit drivers or application – coordinator that issues PREPARE on both sides. For simulation, we prepare the local and then simulate remote prepare on Branch B manually (see below).

Option B: connect and find the session that did dblink_axec (I may need to control remote session).

In a distributed database simulation on Branch B, i can initiate a transaction and prepare it for a two-phase commit by executing BEGIN; followed by my SQL operations, then marking it as ready with PREPARE TRANSACTION 'dist_tx_001_remote';. At this stage, the transaction is not yet committed, allowing the coordinating node to decide on commit or rollback, ensuring atomicity across nodes. I can later finalize the transaction using COMMIT PREPARED 'dist_tx_001_remote';. To inspect all prepared transactions waiting for the second phase similar to the DBA_2PC_PENDING view in Oracle i can query PostgreSQL's system view pg_prepared_xacts, which lists details such as transaction ID, owner, and preparation time, helping DBAs monitor and manage pending distributed transactions:

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# \c parkingsystem_branch_b;
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_b" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_b=# SELECT * FROM pg_prepared_xacts;
 transaction | gid | prepared | owner | database
-------------+-----+----------+-------+----------
(0 rows)
```

Commit prepared:

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# COMMIT PREPARED 'dist_tx_001';
ERROR:  prepared transaction with identifier "dist_tx_001" does not exist
parkingsystem_branch_b=# PREPARE TRANSACTION 'dist_tx_001';
WARNING:  there is no transaction in progress
ROLLBACK
parkingsystem_branch_b=# COMMIT PREPARED 'dist_tx_001';
ERROR:  prepared transaction with identifier "dist_tx_001" does not exist
parkingsystem_branch_b=#
```

If something went wrong, i can ROLLBACK PREPARED 'dist_tx_001'

Question 5: Distributed rollback and recovery, simulate network failure and recovery

To simulate a network failure during a distributed transaction, the process begins by initiating a distributed operation and issuing a PREPARE TRANSACTION command on one of the

participating nodes. This action saves the transaction state, awaiting a final commit or rollback instruction. Next, a network disruption or forced session termination is introduced on the other participating node to emulate a communication failure between the databases. After the failure, the command pg_prepared_xacts is used to inspect any unresolved or in-doubt transactions remaining in a prepared state. Finally, from a database administrator session, the transaction can be manually resolved using either COMMIT PREPARED to finalize the changes or ROLLBACK PREPARED to undo them. This procedure demonstrates PostgreSQL's robustness in handling distributed failures and ensuring transactional consistency through manual recovery in two-phase commit scenarios.

Example: On Branch B: start a transaction, insert, and PREPARE TRANSACTION 'tx_for_recovery'. In a different session: simulate failure by permitting the session (pg_terminate_backend(paid)) or kill process.

Then as superuser:

```
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_b" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_b=# SELECT * FROM pg_prepared_xacts;
 transaction | gid | prepared | owner | database
-------------+-----+----------+-------+----------
(0 rows)
```

Force rollback:

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# ROLLBACK PREPARED 'tx_for_recovery';
ERROR:  prepared transaction with identifier "tx_for_recovery" does not exist
```

Or force commit (if safe)

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# COMMIT PREPARED 'tx_for_recovery';
ERROR:  prepared transaction with identifier "tx_for_recovery" does not exist
parkingsystem_branch_b=#
```

Question 6: Distributed concurrency control

Description & Key Deliverables: Demonstrate a lock conflict by running two sessions that update the same record from different nodes. Query DBA_LOCKS and interpret results.

To demonstrate a locking conflict between two concurrent sessions, begin by opening Session 1 on Branch A and executing a transaction that updates a specific record in the parking.space table, such as setting status = 'OCCUPIED' for spaceid = 1, without committing. This holds an exclusive lock on that row. Next, open Session 2 (on Branch A or remotely through FDW) and attempt to update the same record—for example, changing status to 'MAINTENANCE'. The second update will block until the first transaction is either committed or rolled back. I can observe the active locks using queries on the pg_locks or pg_stat_activity system views to view which sessions hold or wait for locks. After observing the blocking behavior, issue a ROLLBACK in both sessions to release the locks and restore normal operation.

Demonstrate locking conflict between two sessions updating same record.

Step A (Session 1 on Branch A):

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# BEGIN;
BEGIN
parkingsystem_branch_a=*# -- Acquire exclusive lock on a specific parking.space row:
parkingsystem_branch_a=*# UPDATE parking.space SET status = 'OCCUPIED' WHERE spaceid = 1;
UPDATE 1
parkingsystem_branch_a=*# -- Do NOT commit yet. This transaction holds the lock.
```

Step B (Session 2 on Branch A or Branch B using FDW/remote update):

```
parkingsystem_branch_b=# -- Attempt to update the same space:
parkingsystem_branch_b=# BEGIN;
BEGIN
parkingsystem_branch_b=*# UPDATE parking.space SET status = 'MAINTENANCE' WHERE spaceid = 1;
ERROR:  new row for relation "space" violates check constraint "space_status_check"
DETAIL:  Failing row contains (1, 1, S1, MAINTENANCE, CAR).
parkingsystem_branch_b=!# -- This will block until session 1 commits/rollbacks.
```

Question 7: Parallel data loading/ ETL simulation

The approach involves partitioning the target table to enable parallel data loading and insertion. For instance, by partitioning the parking.txn table based on the lotid column, each partition can be loaded independently using separate COPY or INSERT workers. This strategy allows multiple parallel processes to write data simultaneously into different partitions, significantly improving data ingestion performance and overall system throughput while reducing contention on a single table.

1. Create partitioned table example

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# DROP TABLE IF EXISTS parking.txn_part;
NOTICE:  table "txn_part" does not exist, skipping
DROP TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.txn_part (
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   txn_id bigint,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   txn_time timestamp,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   amount integer,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   txn_type text,
parkingsystem_branch_a(#   lotid int
parkingsystem_branch_a(# ) PARTITION BY HASH (lotid);
CREATE TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_a=# select * from parking.txn_part;
 txn_id | txn_time | amount | txn_type | lotid
--------+----------+--------+----------+-------
(0 rows)
```

Create 4 partitions:

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.txn_p0 PARTITION OF parking.txn_part FOR VALUES WITH (MODULUS 4, REMAINDER 0);
CREATE TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.txn_p1 PARTITION OF parking.txn_part FOR VALUES WITH (MODULUS 4, REMAINDER 1);
CREATE TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.txn_p2 PARTITION OF parking.txn_part FOR VALUES WITH (MODULUS 4, REMAINDER 2);
CREATE TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_a=# CREATE TABLE parking.txn_p3 PARTITION OF parking.txn_part FOR VALUES WITH (MODULUS 4, REMAINDER 3);
CREATE TABLE
parkingsystem_branch_a=# select * from parking.txn_p0;
 txn_id | txn_time | amount | txn_type | lotid
--------+----------+--------+----------+-------
(0 rows)


parkingsystem_branch_a=# select * from parking.txn_p1;
 txn_id | txn_time | amount | txn_type | lotid
--------+----------+--------+----------+-------
(0 rows)


parkingsystem_branch_a=# select * from parking.txn_p2;
 txn_id | txn_time | amount | txn_type | lotid
--------+----------+--------+----------+-------
(0 rows)


parkingsystem_branch_a=# select * from parking.txn_p3;
 txn_id | txn_time | amount | txn_type | lotid
--------+----------+--------+----------+-------
(0 rows)
```

2. Use multiple client processes to COPY data into different partitions concurrently:

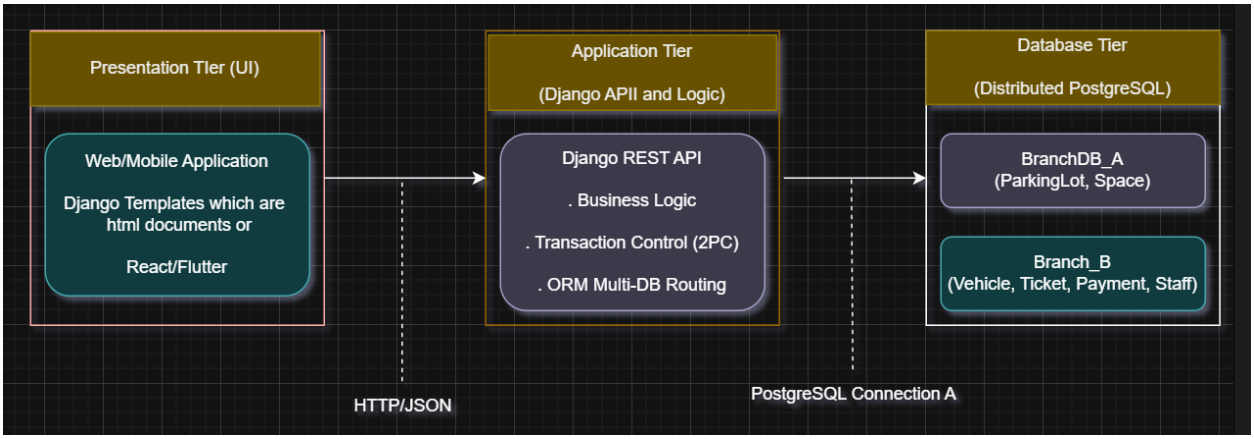
To enhance data loading performance, multiple parallel COPY commands can be executed from the shell, each targeting a specific partition of the table. For example, you can run commands such as psql -d parkingsystem_branch_a -c "COPY parking.txn_p0 FROM STDIN WITH (FORMAT csv)" < data_p0.csv & and psql -d parkingsystem_branch_a -c "COPY parking.txn_p1 FROM STDIN WITH (FORMAT csv)" < data_p1.csv &, enabling four parallel COPY processes to load data concurrently and improve throughput significantly. Alternatively, when restoring a database from a directory-format dump, the pg_restore -j N option can be used

to parallelize the restoration process. After loading, it is important to run ANALYZE to refresh table statistics and capture EXPLAIN ANALYZE results for runtime comparison.

Question 8: Three-Tier client – Server architecture design (using Python Django code)

The three-tier client–server architecture, illustrated separately in the provided draw.io or Graphviz diagram, is composed of three key layers. The Presentation Tier serves as the Web or Mobile User Interface, allowing users to interact with the system seamlessly. The Application Tier functions as the API server implemented using Python Django, or Node.js, or Java which manages business logic, handles data fragmentation, and coordinates two-phase commit (2PC) operations to ensure transaction consistency across distributed databases. Finally, the Database Tier includes the PostgreSQL instances for Branch A and Branch B, interconnected through Foreign Data Wrapper (FDW) or dblink, enabling distributed data storage, retrieval, and synchronization between multiple nodes.

Three-Tier architecture using Python Django (from draw.io)



	Tier	Description	Technology used
1	Presentation Tier (UI)	Web or mobile interface where staff and users interact with the parking system (check available spaces, book parking, issue tickets, make payments)	Django Templates (React / Flutter)
2	Application Tier (Django API and Logic)	The business logic and coordination layer implemented in Django. It routes requests, applies rules (no double booking), and coordinates transactions	Python Django + Django REST Framework

		between the two PostgreSQL databases (Branch A and Branch B).	
3	Database Tier (Distributed PostgreSQL)	Two PostgreSQL nodes: • BranchDB_A: ParkingLot, Space • BranchDB_B: Vehicle, Ticket, Staff, Payment. Where BranchDB_A and BranchDB_B are linked with postgres_fdw or dblink for distributed queries.	PostgreSQL 16 with FDW/dblink

Question 9: Distributed query optimization

Description and Key Deliverables: Use EXPLAIN PLAN and DBMS_XPLAN.DISPLAY to analyze a distributed join. Discuss optimizer strategy and how data movement is minimized.

The EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, BUFFERS, VERBOSE) command is used to examine and analyze the execution plan of distributed joins in PostgreSQL, providing detailed insights into query performance, memory usage, and I/O operations. For example, when executed on Branch A, it can be used to analyze a join operation between a local table and a remote table accessed through Foreign Data Wrapper (FDW). This helps identify how the query planner distributes work across nodes, the efficiency of data retrieval, and potential optimization opportunities in a distributed database setup.

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, BUFFERS)
parkingsystem_branch_a-# SELECT s.spaceid, s.spaceno, p.name, p.location
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM parking.space s
parkingsystem_branch_a-# JOIN parking_fdw.parkinglot p ON s.lotid = p.lotid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# WHERE p.location LIKE 'B%';
                                                    QUERY PLAN
-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
 Hash Join  (cost=103.25..124.74 rows=2 width=71) (actual time=7.522..7.543 rows=100 loops=1)
   Hash Cond: (p.lotid = s.lotid)
   Buffers: shared hit=1 dirtied=1
   ->  Foreign Scan on parkinglot p  (cost=100.00..121.21 rows=4 width=68) (actual time=7.408..7.409 rows=2 loops=1)
   ->  Hash  (cost=2.00..2.00 rows=100 width=11) (actual time=0.074..0.075 rows=100 loops=1)
         Buckets: 1024  Batches: 1  Memory Usage: 13kB
         Buffers: shared hit=1 dirtied=1
         ->  Seq Scan on space s  (cost=0.00..2.00 rows=100 width=11) (actual time=0.042..0.051 rows=100 loops=1)
               Buffers: shared hit=1 dirtied=1
 Planning:
   Buffers: shared hit=136 read=1
 Planning Time: 16.432 ms
 Execution Time: 90.556 ms
(13 rows)
```

With no explain (analyze, buffers)

```
parkingticketingsystem=# \c parkingsystem_branch_a;
You are now connected to database "parkingsystem_branch_a" as user "postgres".
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SELECT s.spaceid, s.spaceno, p.name, p.location
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM parking.space s
parkingsystem_branch_a-# JOIN parking_fdw.parkinglot p ON s.lotid = p.lotid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# WHERE p.location LIKE 'B%';
 spaceid | spaceno |  name   | location
---------+---------+---------+----------
      99 | S50     | Main B1 | B-01
      97 | S49     | Main B1 | B-01
      95 | S48     | Main B1 | B-01
      93 | S47     | Main B1 | B-01
      91 | S46     | Main B1 | B-01
      89 | S45     | Main B1 | B-01
      87 | S44     | Main B1 | B-01
      85 | S43     | Main B1 | B-01
      83 | S42     | Main B1 | B-01
      81 | S41     | Main B1 | B-01
      79 | S40     | Main B1 | B-01
      77 | S39     | Main B1 | B-01
      75 | S38     | Main B1 | B-01
      73 | S37     | Main B1 | B-01
      71 | S36     | Main B1 | B-01
      69 | S35     | Main B1 | B-01
      67 | S34     | Main B1 | B-01
      65 | S33     | Main B1 | B-01
      63 | S32     | Main B1 | B-01
      61 | S31     | Main B1 | B-01
      59 | S30     | Main B1 | B-01
      57 | S29     | Main B1 | B-01
      55 | S28     | Main B1 | B-01
      53 | S27     | Main B1 | B-01
      51 | S26     | Main B1 | B-01
      49 | S25     | Main B1 | B-01
      47 | S24     | Main B1 | B-01
```

45	S23	Main B1	B-01
43	S22	Main B1	B-01
41	S21	Main B1	B-01
39	S20	Main B1	B-01
37	S19	Main B1	B-01
35	S18	Main B1	B-01
33	S17	Main B1	B-01
31	S16	Main B1	B-01
29	S15	Main B1	B-01
27	S14	Main B1	B-01
25	S13	Main B1	B-01
23	S12	Main B1	B-01
21	S11	Main B1	B-01
19	S10	Main B1	B-01
17	S9	Main B1	B-01
15	S8	Main B1	B-01
13	S7	Main B1	B-01
11	S6	Main B1	B-01
9	S5	Main B1	B-01
7	S4	Main B1	B-01
5	S3	Main B1	B-01
3	S2	Main B1	B-01
1	S1	Main B1	B-01
100	S50	B East	B-02
98	S49	B East	B-02
96	S48	B East	B-02
94	S47	B East	B-02
92	S46	B East	B-02
90	S45	B East	B-02
88	S44	B East	B-02
86	S43	B East	B-02
84	S42	B East	B-02

82	S41	B East	B-02
80	S40	B East	B-02
78	S39	B East	B-02
76	S38	B East	B-02
74	S37	B East	B-02
72	S36	B East	B-02
70	S35	B East	B-02
68	S34	B East	B-02
66	S33	B East	B-02
64	S32	B East	B-02
62	S31	B East	B-02
60	S30	B East	B-02
58	S29	B East	B-02
56	S28	B East	B-02
54	S27	B East	B-02
52	S26	B East	B-02
50	S25	B East	B-02
48	S24	B East	B-02
46	S23	B East	B-02
44	S22	B East	B-02
42	S21	B East	B-02
40	S20	B East	B-02
38	S19	B East	B-02
36	S18	B East	B-02
34	S17	B East	B-02
32	S16	B East	B-02
30	S15	B East	B-02
28	S14	B East	B-02
26	S13	B East	B-02
24	S12	B East	B-02
22	S11	B East	B-02
20	S10	B East	B-02
18	S9	B East	B-02
16	S8	B East	B-02

```
      16 | S8      | B East  | B-02
      14 | S7      | B East  | B-02
      12 | S6      | B East  | B-02
      10 | S5      | B East  | B-02
       8 | S4      | B East  | B-02
       6 | S3      | B East  | B-02
       4 | S2      | B East  | B-02
       2 | S1      | B East  | B-02
(100 rows)
```

To optimize the performance of postgres_fdw in distributed database environments, two key tuning options can be applied. First, enabling use_remote_estimate = on in the foreign server or foreign table configuration allows PostgreSQL's query planner to use cost estimates from the remote server's optimizer, resulting in more accurate and efficient execution plans. Second, adjusting the fetch_size parameter, for example, using ALTER FOREIGN TABLE ... OPTIONS (SET fetch_size '1000'); controls the number of rows fetched per batch from the remote server, helping to balance memory usage and network efficiency for improved query performance.

Example: *ALTER SERVER branch_b_srv OPTIONS (SET use_remote_estimate 'on')*

Question 10: Performance benchmark and report

To evaluate system performance under different architectures, the same complex query can be executed in three distinct ways. First, in the centralized setup, the query is run on a single database containing all the data, serving as the baseline for performance comparison. Second, in the parallel mode, the query is executed on a large table with parallel workers enabled—leveraging PostgreSQL's parallel processing settings to utilize multiple CPU cores for faster execution. Finally, in the distributed configuration, the query is executed using Foreign Data Wrapper (FDW) joins between Branch A and Branch B, demonstrating how distributed databases can collaboratively process data across multiple nodes while maintaining consistency and scalability.

Example complex query:

1. Centralized: centralized data is in parkingtecketingsystem database with no schema created.

Connect to parkingtecketingsystem and run:

With explain (analyze, butters)

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# \c parkingtecketingsystem;
connection to server at "localhost" (::1), port 5432 failed: FATAL:  database "parkingtecketingsystem" does not exist
Previous connection kept
parkingsystem_branch_a=# \c parkingticketingsystem;
You are now connected to database "parkingticketingsystem" as user "postgres".
parkingticketingsystem=# EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, BUFFERS)
parkingticketingsystem-# SELECT pl.location, COUNT(t.ticketid) AS open_tickets, SUM(p.amount) AS revenue
parkingticketingsystem-# FROM parkinglot pl
parkingticketingsystem-# JOIN space s ON s.lotid = pl.lotid
parkingticketingsystem-# LEFT JOIN ticket t ON t.spaceid = s.spaceid AND t.status = 'ACTIVE'
parkingticketingsystem-# LEFT JOIN payment p ON p.ticketid = t.ticketid
parkingticketingsystem-# GROUP BY pl.location
parkingticketingsystem-# ORDER BY revenue DESC
parkingticketingsystem-# LIMIT 20;
                                                                    QUERY PLAN
--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
 Limit  (cost=69.02..69.07 rows=20 width=358) (actual time=2.683..2.685 rows=5 loops=1)
   Buffers: shared hit=3 read=3
   ->  Sort  (cost=69.02..69.32 rows=120 width=358) (actual time=2.681..2.684 rows=5 loops=1)
         Sort Key: (sum(p.amount)) DESC
         Sort Method: quicksort  Memory: 25kB
         Buffers: shared hit=3 read=3
         ->  HashAggregate  (cost=64.33..65.83 rows=120 width=358) (actual time=2.131..2.135 rows=5 loops=1)
               Group Key: pl.location
               Batches: 1  Memory Usage: 40kB
               Buffers: shared read=3
               ->  Hash Join  (cost=45.21..61.48 rows=380 width=350) (actual time=2.105..2.113 rows=10 loops=1)
                     Hash Cond: (s.lotid = pl.lotid)
                     Buffers: shared read=3
                     ->  Hash Left Join  (cost=32.51..47.76 rows=380 width=48) (actual time=0.905..0.910 rows=10 loops=1)
                           Hash Cond: (s.spaceid = t.spaceid)
                           Buffers: shared read=2
                           ->  Seq Scan on space s  (cost=0.00..13.80 rows=380 width=32) (actual time=0.445..0.446 rows=10 loops=1)
                                 Buffers: shared read=1
```

```
                           ->  Hash  (cost=32.49..32.49 rows=2 width=48) (actual time=0.443..0.444 rows=0 loops=1)
                                 Buckets: 1024  Batches: 1  Memory Usage: 8kB
                                 Buffers: shared read=1
                                 ->  Nested Loop Left Join  (cost=0.15..32.49 rows=2 width=48) (actual time=0.443..0.443 rows=0 loops=1)
                                       Buffers: shared read=1
                                       ->  Seq Scan on ticket t  (cost=0.00..16.12 rows=2 width=32) (actual time=0.442..0.442 rows=0 loops=1)
                                             Filter: ((status)::text = 'ACTIVE'::text)
                                             Rows Removed by Filter: 5
                                             Buffers: shared read=1
                                       ->  Index Scan using payment_ticketid_key on payment p  (cost=0.15..8.17 rows=1 width=32) (never executed)
                                             Index Cond: (ticketid = t.ticketid)
                     ->  Hash  (cost=11.20..11.20 rows=120 width=334) (actual time=1.075..1.076 rows=5 loops=1)
                           Buckets: 1024  Batches: 1  Memory Usage: 9kB
                           Buffers: shared read=1
                           ->  Seq Scan on parkinglot pl  (cost=0.00..11.20 rows=120 width=334) (actual time=0.489..0.491 rows=5 loops=1)
                                 Buffers: shared read=1
 Planning:
   Buffers: shared hit=277 read=18
 Planning Time: 19.532 ms
 Execution Time: 2.797 ms
(38 rows)


parkingticketingsystem=#
```

With no explain (analyze, butters)

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# \c parkingticketingsystem;
You are now connected to database "parkingticketingsystem" as user "postgres".
parkingticketingsystem=# SELECT pl.location, COUNT(t.ticketid) AS open_tickets, SUM(p.amount) AS revenue
parkingticketingsystem-# FROM parkinglot pl
parkingticketingsystem-# JOIN space s ON s.lotid = pl.lotid
parkingticketingsystem-# LEFT JOIN ticket t ON t.spaceid = s.spaceid AND t.status = 'ACTIVE'
parkingticketingsystem-# LEFT JOIN payment p ON p.ticketid = t.ticketid
parkingticketingsystem-# GROUP BY pl.location
parkingticketingsystem-# ORDER BY revenue DESC
parkingticketingsystem-# LIMIT 20;
     location      | open_tickets | revenue
-------------------+--------------+---------
 University Campus |            0 |
 Airport Road      |            0 |
 City Mall         |            0 |
 Downtown          |            0 |
 Hospital          |            0 |
(5 rows)
```

2. Parallel: same query on large table in Branch A with parallel workers enabled

With explain (analyze, butters)

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=#
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SET max_parallel_workers_per_gather = 4;
SET
parkingsystem_branch_a=# EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, BUFFERS)
parkingsystem_branch_a-# SELECT pl.location, COUNT(t.ticketid) AS open_tickets, SUM(p.amount) AS revenue
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM parking.parkinglot pl
parkingsystem_branch_a-# JOIN parking.space s ON s.lotid = pl.lotid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LEFT JOIN parking.ticket t ON t.spaceid = s.spaceid AND t.status = 'ACTIVE'
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LEFT JOIN parking.txn p ON p.txn_id = t.ticketid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# GROUP BY pl.location
parkingsystem_branch_a-# ORDER BY revenue DESC
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LIMIT 20;
                                                                 QUERY PLAN
-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------
 Limit  (cost=39997.47..39997.52 rows=20 width=48) (actual time=0.959..0.963 rows=2 loops=1)
   Buffers: shared hit=12 dirtied=1
   ->  Sort  (cost=39997.47..39997.72 rows=100 width=48) (actual time=0.959..0.961 rows=2 loops=1)
         Sort Key: (sum(p.amount)) DESC
         Sort Method: quicksort  Memory: 25kB
         Buffers: shared hit=12 dirtied=1
         ->  GroupAggregate  (cost=39992.81..39994.81 rows=100 width=48) (actual time=0.909..0.923 rows=2 loops=1)
               Group Key: pl.location
               Buffers: shared hit=9 dirtied=1
               ->  Sort  (cost=39992.81..39993.06 rows=100 width=40) (actual time=0.350..0.358 rows=100 loops=1)
                     Sort Key: pl.location
                     Sort Method: quicksort  Memory: 28kB
                     Buffers: shared hit=9 dirtied=1
                     ->  Nested Loop Left Join  (cost=21.21..39989.49 rows=100 width=40) (actual time=0.107..0.192 rows=100 loops=1)
                           Join Filter: (t.spaceid = s.spaceid)
                           Buffers: shared hit=6 dirtied=1
                           ->  Nested Loop  (cost=0.16..6.42 rows=100 width=36) (actual time=0.049..0.110 rows=100 loops=1)
                                 Buffers: shared hit=5
                                 ->  Seq Scan on space s  (cost=0.00..2.00 rows=100 width=8) (actual time=0.027..0.035 rows=100 loops=1)
                                       Buffers: shared hit=1
```

```
                                    Buffers: shared hit=1
                              ->  Memoize  (cost=0.16..0.66 rows=1 width=36) (actual time=0.000..0.000 rows=1 loops=100)
                                    Cache Key: s.lotid
                                    Cache Mode: logical
                                    Hits: 98  Misses: 2  Evictions: 0  Overflows: 0  Memory Usage: 1kB
                                    Buffers: shared hit=4
                                    ->  Index Scan using parkinglot_pkey on parkinglot pl  (cost=0.15..0.65 rows=1 width=36) (actual time=0.009..0.009 rows=1 loops=2)
                                          Index Cond: (lotid = s.lotid)
                                          Buffers: shared hit=4
                        ->  Materialize  (cost=21.05..39977.08 rows=4 width=12) (actual time=0.001..0.001 rows=0 loops=100)
                              Buffers: shared hit=1 dirtied=1
                              ->  Hash Right Join  (cost=21.05..39977.06 rows=4 width=12) (actual time=0.053..0.054 rows=0 loops=1)
                                    Hash Cond: (p.txn_id = t.ticketid)
                                    Buffers: shared hit=1 dirtied=1
                                    ->  Seq Scan on txn p  (cost=0.00..34706.00 rows=2000000 width=8) (never executed)
                                    ->  Hash  (cost=21.00..21.00 rows=4 width=8) (actual time=0.036..0.036 rows=0 loops=1)
                                          Buckets: 1024  Batches: 1  Memory Usage: 8kB
                                          Buffers: shared hit=1 dirtied=1
                                          ->  Seq Scan on ticket t  (cost=0.00..21.00 rows=4 width=8) (actual time=0.035..0.035 rows=0 loops=1)
                                                Filter: (status = 'ACTIVE'::text)
                                                Buffers: shared hit=1 dirtied=1
Planning:
  Buffers: shared hit=292 read=2
Planning Time: 10.609 ms
Execution Time: 1.052 ms
(44 rows)
```

With no explain (analyze, butters)

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# SELECT pl.location, COUNT(t.ticketid) AS open_tickets, SUM(p.amount) AS revenue
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM parking.parkinglot pl
parkingsystem_branch_a-# JOIN parking.space s ON s.lotid = pl.lotid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LEFT JOIN parking.ticket t ON t.spaceid = s.spaceid AND t.status = 'ACTIVE'
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LEFT JOIN parking.txn p ON p.txn_id = t.ticketid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# GROUP BY pl.location
parkingsystem_branch_a-# ORDER BY revenue DESC
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LIMIT 20;
 location | open_tickets | revenue
----------+--------------+---------
 A-01     |            0 |
 A-02     |            0 |
```

3. Distributed: on Branch A join to Branch B via FDW

```
parkingsystem_branch_a=# DROP DATABASE parkingsystem;
ERROR:  database "parkingsystem" does not exist
parkingsystem_branch_a=# DROP DATABASE parkingsystem_main;
ERROR:  database "parkingsystem_main" is being accessed by other users
DETAIL:  There is 1 other session using the database.
parkingsystem_branch_a=# EXPLAIN (ANALYZE, BUFFERS)
parkingsystem_branch_a-# SELECT pl.location, COUNT(t.ticketid) AS open_tickets, SUM(p.amount) AS revenue
parkingsystem_branch_a-# FROM parking.parkinglot pl
parkingsystem_branch_a-# JOIN parking.space s ON s.lotid = pl.lotid
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LEFT JOIN parking.ticket t ON t.spaceid = s.spaceid AND t.status = 'ACTIVE'
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LEFT JOIN parking_fdw.payment p ON p.ticketid = t.ticketid  -- remote payments via FDW
parkingsystem_branch_a-# GROUP BY pl.location
parkingsystem_branch_a-# ORDER BY revenue DESC
parkingsystem_branch_a-# LIMIT 20;
ERROR:  column p.amount does not exist
LINE 2: ....location, COUNT(t.ticketid) AS open_tickets, SUM(p.amount) ...
                                                         ^
```

Conclusion

This lab on Parallel and Distributed Databases using PostgreSQL successfully demonstrated the design, implementation, and performance evaluation of a distributed data management system based on the Smart Parking Management and Ticketing System. Through a series of structured experiments, the project highlighted key concepts such as horizontal and vertical fragmentation, foreign data wrappers (FDW) for cross-node communication, and two-phase commit (2PC) for ensuring atomic distributed transactions. The implementation of parallel query execution and parallel ETL loading highlighted PostgreSQL's ability to optimize resource utilization and enhance query performance across multiple CPUs. Furthermore, tasks involving concurrency control, distributed rollback and recovery, and query optimization provided practical insights into managing real-world challenges like locking conflicts, network failures, and data movement efficiency. The integration of the three-tier architecture comprising the presentation, application, and database layers demonstrated how distributed systems can be seamlessly integrated with modern web technologies such as Python Django for coordinated transaction processing. Overall, the lab provided a comprehensive understanding of how PostgreSQL supports scalable, reliable, and high-performing distributed database architectures suitable for enterprise-level applications.